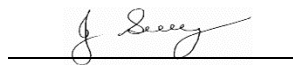


SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods , plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	SEWAGE WASTE DISPOSAL – VACUUM TRUCKS - TASWATER	Project:	TasWater - Waste Water Treatment Plants
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025 SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	Newnham & Ti Tree Bend WWTP Plants
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training and skill.	Un-trained persons could cause injury to themselves and others.	1	1. All persons involved in the Sewage Waste Disposal must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card' and a current TasWater Induction Card. A site-specific induction will also be required for the specific TasWater facility, please check with the facility attendant on your first arrival to site for induction. 2. All persons involved in unloading the vacuum truck must be suitably trained and competent in Vacuum Loading/unloading 3. Lead operator/driver to always supervise any new workers whilst on-site	Workers	2
Disposal Site Selection	Contamination of waste disposal site with an inappropriate waste	2	<u>Launceston</u> • If the sewage waste does contain coarse aggregates/gravel components Unload at – Newnham WWTP  • If the sewage waste contains no aggregates/gravel components Unload at – Ti Tree Bend WWTP  <u>All other cities/areas in Tasmania</u> Contact local TasWater Rep or Management for Information	Driver	3

Site Arrival	Undirected persons could take a wrong turn toward drying beds, resulting in bogs or truck roll-over	1	1. On site arrival park the truck at the front gate to the facility. Read the conditions of entry for the specific facility 2. Call the number indicated on the entry sign and request a location for disposal of TasWater Sewage 3. Indicate to the facility attendant where the sewage was collected	Driver	3
Personal Protective Clothing & Equipment (PPE)	Bodily injuries Sewer Spills and splashes onto workers' eyes / skin	1	All workers are to wear required PPE in accordance with TasWater Policy: • Highly Visible Workwear – Long Pants & Shirt (Sleeves Down) • Safety Boots • Hard Hat – No caps underneath • Safety Glasses - AS/NZS1337 • Prescription Safety Glasses (Where Applicable) • Hearing Protection (Where Required) • Construction Gloves Cut Factor >4 & Glove Clip • Disposable coveralls (where required) • Face Sheild (where signed)	Workers	2
Vacuum Truck	Plant, hydraulic ram, unloading hose or door failure	1	1. Pre-start check to be completed prior to start of works each day. 2. Plant to be properly maintained and checked before use. 3. In all instances of mechanical or hose failure, cordon off the area, advise the TasWater attendant and contact management immediately	Workers	2
Site Hazard Assessment (Visual Checklist)	Trip, slip and fall hazards.	2	1. Clear any obstacles from around unloading area before starting the unloading process 2. Keep access ways clear of trip hazards around the truck	Workers	3
	UV Exposure; skin cancer.	1	1. Be sun smart wear a broad brimmed hat, sun/safety glasses, sun protective clothing and 30+ sunscreen.	Workers	2
	Vehicle access Collisions with vehicles or pedestrians.	1	1. Drive only in the designated access /roads/routes. 2. Give way to all pedestrians 3. Do not park vehicles where it will create a hazard to TasWater vehicles or pedestrians. 4. When parking the truck reverse into all unloading or parking spots and the passenger must act as a spotter when reversing	Workers	2
	Un-stable soils.	1	1. Be aware of un-stable soils unstable soils pose a catastrophic risk of roll over, check with the facility attendant on any no go areas around the facility.	Workers	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Falling into a disposal area or drying bed is likely to lead to injury and or rapid asphyxiation and in cases of collapse, there is risk of becoming buried.	1	- Don't work alone: Falling into an unloading area or drying bed or even leaning over the vehicle stoppers can be fatal - Do <u>not ever</u> enter an unloading area or pond	Workers	2
	Unsanitary conditions- bacterial hazards	1	Be alert for unsanitary conditions such as surface effluent or tank spills, use your disposable suits, P2 mask and hand sanitizer, as required, throughout the unloading process	Workers	2
	Explosion	1	Don't ignite flames -Do not light a flame or smoke at or near the Tank whilst unloading - methane gas is explosive. All TasWater facilities have a designated area to smoke, please consult with the attendant	Workers	2
	Fall injury	2	- Workers to use 3 points of contact when climbing up and down from vehicles. - Workers must never stand on the vehicle stoppers or a live edge at a wastewater disposal site	Workers	3
	Low overhead wires - electrocution	1	Operators need to keep vehicles/equipment- hoses. - At least 3 metres from 132,000-volt lines. - At least 6 metres from 132,000 to 330,000-volt lines. - Areas closer than 3m are no go zone. - Use certified spotter if working near powerlines. (3m to 6.4m) - Clarify safe working distances with the facility attendant If in doubt of line voltage keep at least 8 metres away.	Workers	2
	Needle stick injury	1	- Sewer pipe blockages could be due to discarded syringes - Needle collection kits to be available in each vacuum truck. - Any needles are to be disposed of at an approved needle depository Centre Workers to be careful not to put their hands into any liquid waste incase of discarded needles present at all times.	Management Workers	2
Personal Hygiene Considerations	Serious illness even death	1	Sewage waste may be inadvertently ingested or absorbed through the skin due to improper personal hygiene practices. To minimize the possibility of this occurring: Do not eat, drink or smoke in the unloading area.	Workers	2

			2. Always wash hands (minimum) and face before eating, drinking or smoking 3. Wear protective coveralls over work clothes 4. Shower thoroughly after the completion of your work shift 5. Avoid handling foam ear hearing protectors with unwashed/unsanitised hands 6. Immunizations such as tetanus must be kept up to date. Basic primary series of 3 doses - Booster every 10 years and Hepatitis A & B injections are mandatory for all new Paneltec workers	Workers	
Unload Vacuum Truck	Hydraulic ram failure	1	1. Only competent vacuum loading operators are to undertake this process 2. Once the truck has been reversed and rests upon the vehicle stopper, chock the trucks tyres and all PPE shall be adorned 3. Raise the tank/ram and open the rear door (Newnham) 4. Connect unloading hose and commence unloading procedure in accordance with your training (Ti Tree bend) 5. Finish the unloading procedure 6. Lower the tank/ram or disconnect the unloading hose	Driver	2
Truck wash out procedure	Fall from height, Unsanitary conditions- bacterial hazards	1	1. Where the risk of fall is > 2 metres, workers must use a harness clipped to suitable anchorage point on the truck when cleaning/ washing out after use. 2. Following the unloading procedure, lower the tank and move the truck forward 3m from the vehicle stopper 3. Use the hose reel on-site to wash out the tank on the unloading bay 4. Dispose of wash out liquid at treatment plant in accordance with vacuum loading training. Follow all site procedures, disposal area instructions and all safety signs. 5. Do not leave the unloading area until the entire bay is clean and free from effluent 6. Conduct a 360 degree walk around prior to leaving site and ensure all tank doors are isolated and closed with safety catches in place.	Workers	2
Before leaving site	Trip hazards etc Unauthorised entry	2	1. Ensure the unloading area is in the same condition, or better upon departure, exit safely, close gates, etc. advise the facility attendant of your departure if they are not on site. This can be facilitated by calling the number on the gate.	Workers	3

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it influences them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.				
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card				
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training	

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.																
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)																
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022																
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Plant & Equipment for this activity																
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.																
List of plant for this Activity																
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):																

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.